



INDIE & MICRO-SAAS REVENUE, BY THE NUMBERS

Who Actually Makes Money Building SaaS

A data-driven look at 8,782 tracked startups — revenue concentration, category economics, and what actually predicts who wins.

8,782

startups tracked

\$15.4M

combined MRR

\$33.2M

trailing 30-day revenue

646,933

active subscriptions

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A large, thriving — but extremely top-heavy — market

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startups tracked in the dataset

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01**Revenue is a lottery, not a bell curve.**

The top 1% of startups (87 companies) capture 69.5% of all MRR — the median startup earns \$0.

02**AI leads by volume, not efficiency.**

1,430 AI startups generate \$2.25M MRR — the largest category by headcount, not by revenue-per-company.

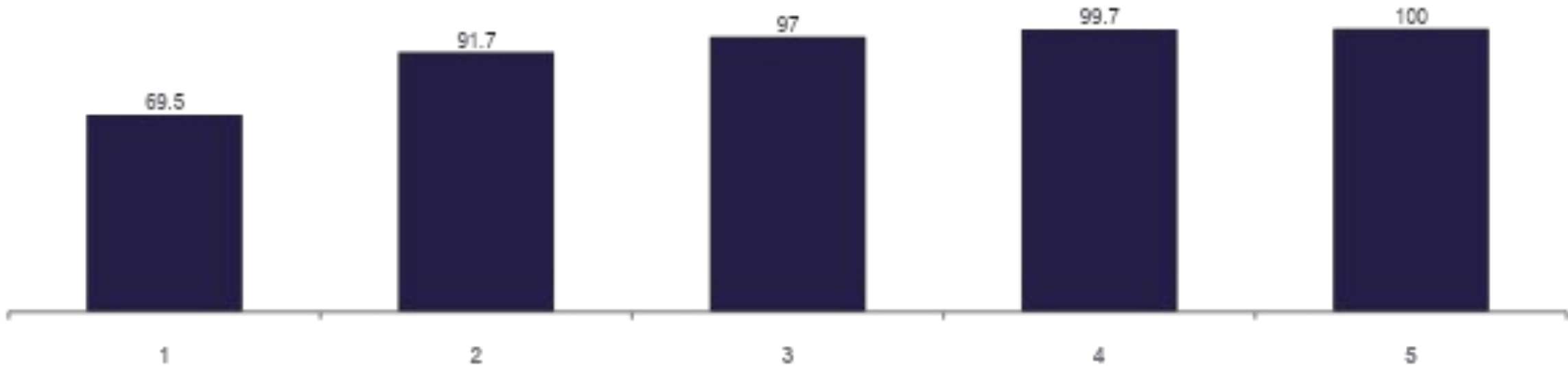
03**Subscriber depth beats social reach.**

Active subscriptions correlate with MRR at 0.90 — X/Twitter followers barely move the needle (0.12).

04**Nearly a quarter of listings are for sale.**

1,952 startups (22%) are on the market, at a median asking price of just \$5,000.

Revenue is brutally concentrated at the top



57.2%

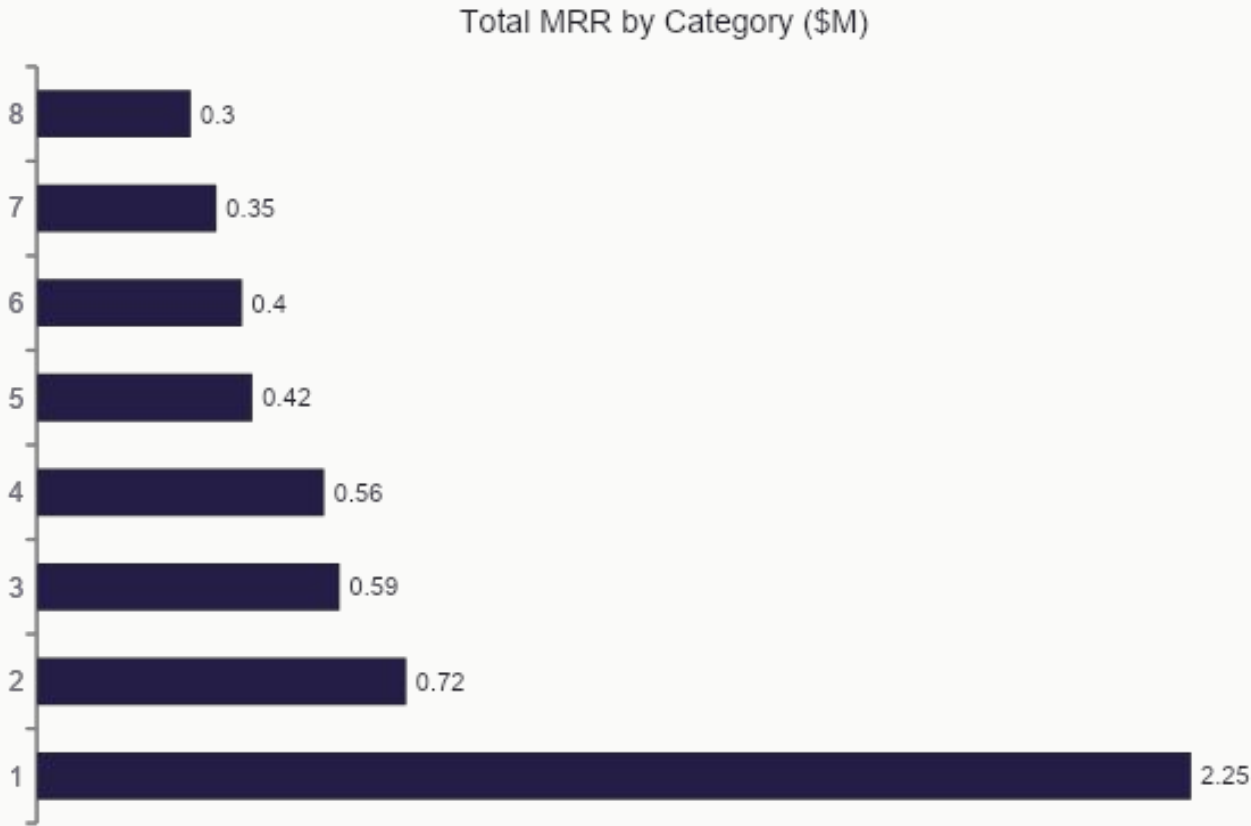
of all listed startups report \$0 in MRR

\$1,752 vs \$0

mean vs. median MRR — pulled entirely by outliers

The bottom 50% (4,391 companies) contribute effectively 0% of total MRR — a hits-driven market, not a distributed one.

AI leads the pack — but the lead is about volume, not efficiency

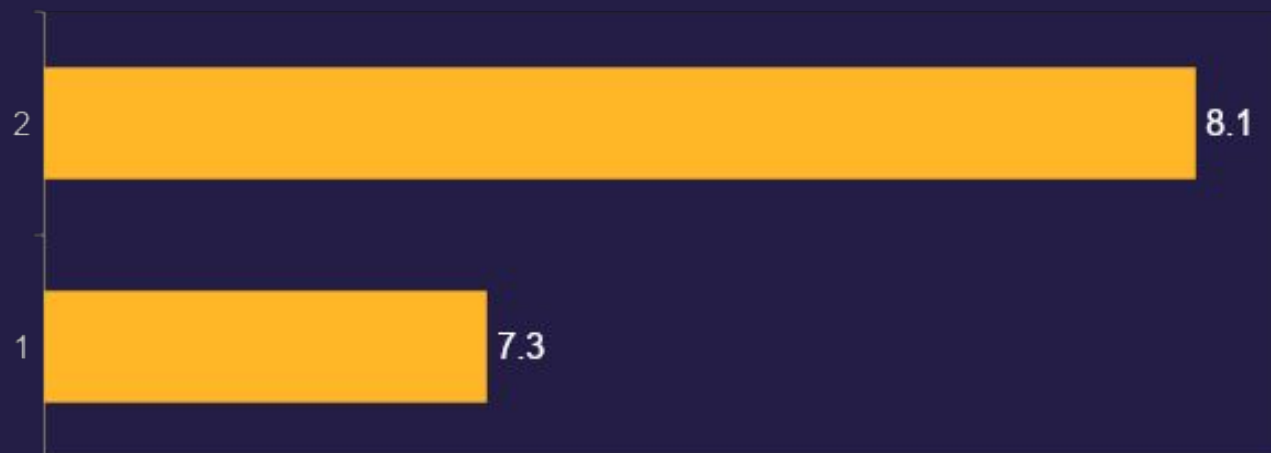


AVG. MRR PER COMPANY — EFFICIENCY

E-comm	\$4,168
Social Media	\$3,123
Analytics	\$2,878
Education	\$2,270
Marketing	\$1,750
AI	\$1,576
SaaS	\$1,366
Mobile Apps	\$1,050

AI's 1,430 startups (16% of the dataset) hold only 14.6% of total MRR — roughly proportional, not dominant. Niche categories like E-comm and Social Media monetize each company harder.

Over half the market's revenue is effectively invisible



\$8.1M

sits behind startups with no disclosed category — larger than every labeled category combined, including AI (\$2.25M).

WHAT'S DRIVING IT

3,264 of 8,782 startups (37%) carry no category label — 498 are explicitly listed as "Stealth Company."

Missing categorization isn't correlated with being small: this segment's average MRR (\$2,488) is above the labeled-category average.

For a platform built on trust and transparency, incomplete metadata on the highest-earning cohort is the single biggest gap in the dataset.

The US anchors the market — everywhere else is long-tail



52.6%

of all disclosed MRR comes from the US alone — 1,657 startups

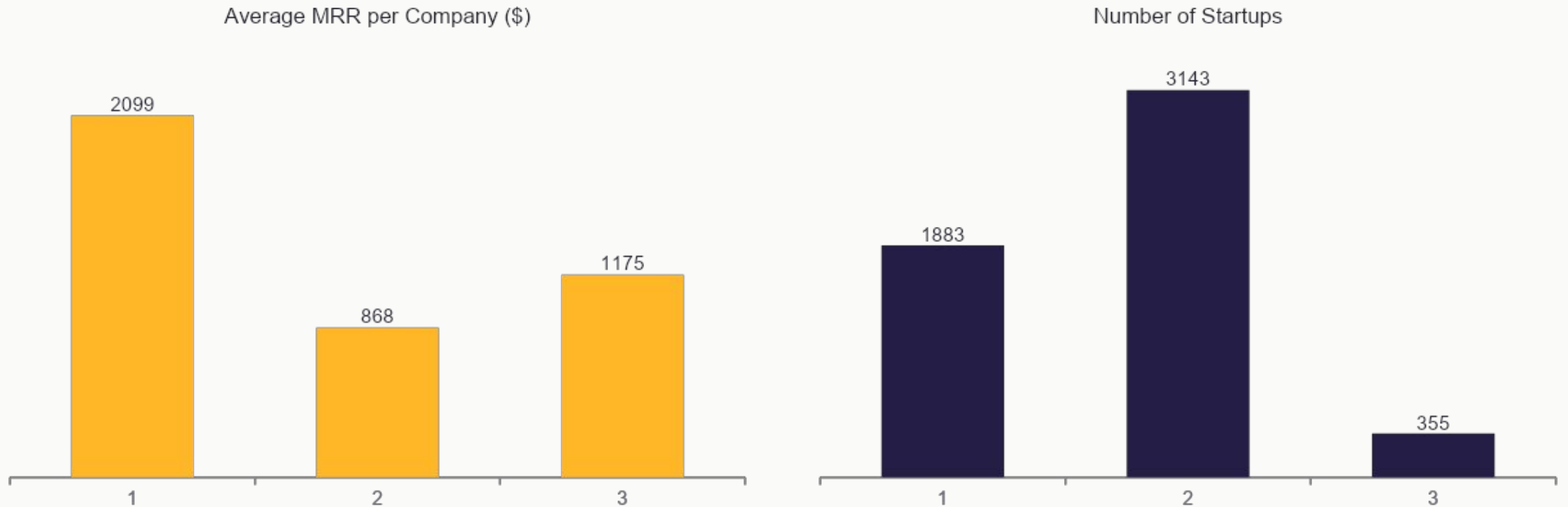
21.3%

of startups (1,869) disclose no country — likely stealth or early-stage

LONG TAIL

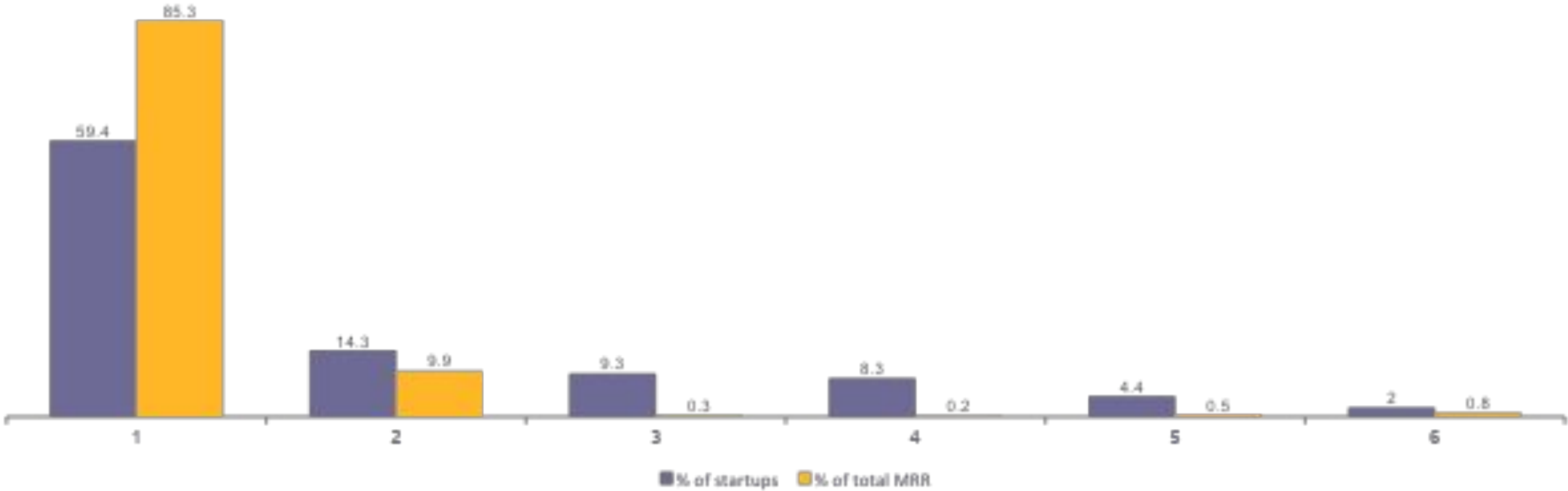
France and the UK are distant #2 and #3; no other single market exceeds 3% of total MRR.

B2B startups are fewer in number but monetize far harder



B2C outnumbers B2B by 1,260 startups, yet B2B earns 2.4x more MRR per company on average — the classic willingness-to-pay gap between businesses and consumers.

Stripe dominates where the revenue actually is



Dodo and Polar together power 17.6% of startups by count but just 0.5% of total MRR — a strong marker of an early-stage, indie-hacker builder segment not yet at scale.

Most startups are flat — but the tails are wild



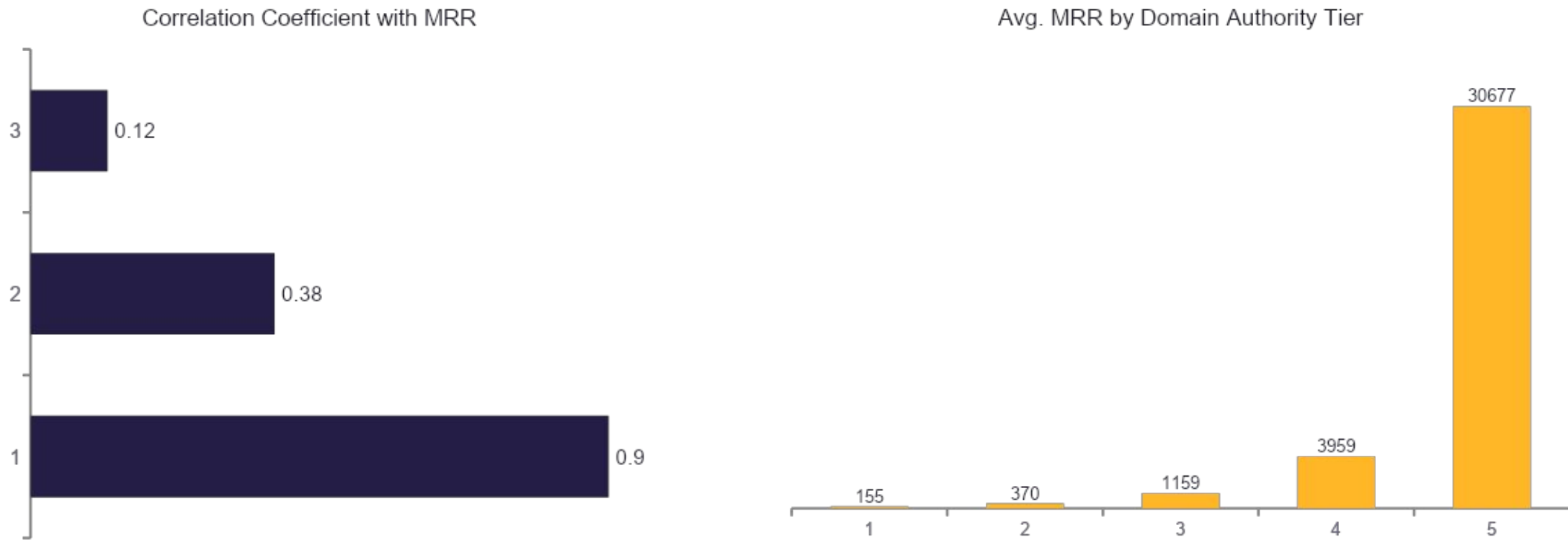
TOP GAINERS (MRR > \$1,000)

FirstRep	Health & Fitness	+10,300%
Hand-Off	E-comm	+4,965%
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	+1,357%
HotelHero.ai	AI	+1,227%

TOP DECLINERS

Barron Tech LLC	Sales	-82.2%
PipeLime	AI	-78.7%
Elofoot	AI	-71.5%
PolyPick	Fintech	-66.6%

Subscriber depth and site authority predict revenue — social reach doesn't



Startups with a domain rating of 51+ earn ~198x the average MRR of unranked domains — SEO and content authority compound revenue far more than audience size on social.

22% of the market is for sale — and it's priced like a garage sale

22.2%

of all startups (1,952) currently for sale

\$5,000

median asking price across all listings

1.0x

median asking price as a multiple of revenue

\$70,678

mean asking price — 14x the median

NOTABLE LISTINGS

Startup	Category	Asking Price	Multiple
1Lookup	SaaS	\$10.0M	2.1x
Project A	Entertainment	\$5.0M	4.9x
POST BRIDGE	—	\$4.2M	8.2x
Launch Club	Marketing	\$3.0M	4.6x
LocalRank.so	Marketing	\$1.8M	5.7x

TAKEAWAY

Most sellers are pricing small, pre-scale products near 1x revenue — real bargains exist for buyers willing to sift volume for quality.

The ten highest-earning startups on TrustMRR

#	Startup	Category	MRR	30d Growth	Subs
1	Stan	—	\$3,569,654	+0.4%	101,590
2	Stealth Company	(undisclosed)	\$747,069	-74.3%	1,677
3	GojiberryAI	AI	\$494,668	+23.6%	4,642
4	Stealth Company	(undisclosed)	\$364,101	+1.0%	2,134
5	Rezi	AI	\$259,701	-4.9%	10,749
6	Kibu	Education	\$234,319	+52.8%	375
7	Cometly	Analytics	\$207,616	+3.0%	307
8	1Lookup	SaaS	\$207,064	-7.5%	655
9	Stealth Company	(France)	\$191,268	+2.4%	8,108
10	Brand On Demand, Inc.	E-comm	\$187,459	-1.8%	3,631

"Stealth Company" entries mask real startup names by platform design; category and identity remain undisclosed at source.

Five takeaways for anyone building on — or buying from — this market

01

Ignore the average.

With 57% of startups at \$0 MRR and the top 1% holding 69.5% of revenue, benchmark against medians and cohorts, never the mean.

02

Category size ≠ category efficiency.

AI leads on headcount, but E-comm and Social Media startups earn 2-3x more revenue per company — pick a lane by unit economics, not hype.

03

Build authority, not just an audience.

Domain rating correlates with MRR 3x more strongly than X followers — SEO and content compounding outperform social reach.

04

B2B still commands a premium.

B2B startups earn 2.4x the average MRR of B2C peers despite being outnumbered — pricing power favors business buyers.

05

Undisclosed listings are the market's blind spot.

\$8.1M in MRR sits behind unlabeled or stealth startups — more transparency here would materially improve buyer and benchmarking confidence.



Thank You

8,782

startups analyzed

Analysis based on the TrustMRR full dataset, frozen 30 July 2026 (8,782 startups).